Now imagine the same transaction at a checkout counter. You count out (verify) 10 $1 bills right in front of the checkout clerk and hand the money to her. In this case, the clerk verifies that you have given her the right number of bills by counting them again. Why? You two are decentralized entities that don’t know each other well enough to trust each other.

That is the situation with airline A and airline B, which are not known to each other. In ASK, they rely on the trust established by the blockchain by verifying and recording the transactions. In addition to the two airlines, other stakeholders may verify the transactions and record the transactions as witnesses.